

1590. Dutch lens-makers Hans and Zacharias Janssen invent the compound microscope.

1676. Antonie van Leeuwenhoek identifies “animalcules”, opening up the field of microbiology.

1866. Louis Pasteur reveals that wine’s fermentation process is caused by germs; his discovery sparks the development of germ theory.

1885. Albert Frank coins the term “mycorrhizae”, in reference to the symbiotic relationship between fungi and tree roots.

1927. Charles Elton publishes Animal Ecology, which sets out many of the fundamental principles of animal behaviour.